Lesson 07 material: Grammar: Gerunds and Infinitives

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 1: Academic Writing Essentials · Psychology

2.4: Grammar Presentation-Gerunds and Infinitives

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.2.4.1. Gerunds

Gerunds are -ing forms of verbs used as nouns. They can function in a sentence as a subject, object, or object of a preposition.

Reading is fun. (subject)

I enjoy reading. (object)

Jose is interested in reading that book. (object of a preposition)

1.2.4.1.1. Subjects

Gerunds can be subjects of sentences. Understanding gerunds as subjects is especially important for writing because of subject-verb agreement. Let's look at the following examples.

1. **Saving your money** can help you reach your goals.
2. **Spending too much money** is not wise.
3. **Baking pies** is my hobby.
4. **Baking pies and crocheting hats** are my hobbies.

Notice that in the third example the verb is singular although the preceding word is plural. This is because the subject is **baking pies**- one action. In the fourth example, the subject is plural because there are two hobbies **baking** and **crocheting**.

1.2.4.1.2. Objects

Gerunds can be directly after a verb. In this structure, they function as an object. Below is a list of verbs followed by gerunds.

admit	anticipate	appreciate	avoid
consider	defend	delay	deny
discontinue	discuss	dislike	enjoy
explain	fear	finish	go (expression)
imagine	keep	mention	miss
practice	recommend	suggest	understand

Table 6 Verbs Followed by Gerunds

1.2.4.1.2.1. Examples

1. Emily enjoys **jogging** in the mornings.
2. I suggest **enrolling** in a math class.
3. Mariam keeps **hitting** her brother.

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Gerunds and Gerund Phrases as Subjects

1.2.4.1.2.2. Exercise 3-Subject and Object Gerund Practice

Complete the sentences about yourself. Use gerunds.

1. _____ is exciting!
2. _____ is not exciting.
3. _____ is easy.
4. _____ is not easy.

5. My favorite activity is _____.
6. Some of my favorite activities are _____ and _____.
7. A great way to improve my English is _____.

1.2.4.1.2.3. Gerund Objects versus Progressive Verbs

Nouns, adjectives, and verbs can be formed using -ing. At times it can be tricky to distinguish their function in a sentence. Look at the examples below. Which -ing is a gerund (noun), and which is a verb in the progressive tense?

1. My hobby is **baking** pies. (noun)
2. The baby is **sleeping** soundly. (verb)
3. The **sleeping** baby looks so peaceful. (adjective)

The first example has a gerund as an object (more technically a subject complement). The sentence can be reversed to read, "Baking pies is my hobby." The second sentence has **sleeping** as a verb in the progressive tense.

Exercise 4-Verb or Gerund?

Look at the sentences below and decide whether the -ing word in the verb, gerund, or adjective.

1. The students were learning writing skills.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
2. The next step is reviewing notes.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
3. Elena's mistake was trusting people she didn't know.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
4. She was talking to her friends and having fun.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
5. The police saw the speeding car immediately.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
6. She is eliminating injustice.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective
7. The increasing prices has caused a lot of uncertainty.
   a. verb
   b. gerund
   c. adjective

1.2.4.1.3. Objects of Prepositions

Gerunds can also be objects of prepositions. This means that they are after a preposition. This use is very common.

1. Jinan is excited **about playing with her cousins**.
2. Bryce got in trouble **for eating all the cookies**.

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Gerunds and Gerund Phrases as Objects of Prepositions

Video: https://youtu.be/CEcdud_Z_6c

1.2.4.1.4. Exercise 5-Gerunds in Chapter 2's Reading

Read the sentences below from this chapter's readings. Determine the function of the gerund in the sentences as either a subject, object, or object of a preposition. Be careful! I've put some -ing words that are verbs or adjectives. In that case, select "not a gerund."

1. People have many different strategies for dealing with stressful situations — some helpful, and some not so helpful. (Paragraph 1)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
2. When you are facing a stressful situation, learn to relax so that you can carefully evaluate how you should respond. (Paragraph 12)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
3. Finding emotional support from others or asking for help can be instrumental to maintain emotional health during a difficult period. (Paragraph 5)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
4. Instead of facing the problem, the person decides to reject its existence or minimize its importance. (Paragraph 9)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
5. For example, a husband who feels angry at his wife may accuse her of being the angry one instead of admitting that he is actually the angry one. (Paragraph 10)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
6. A process involves defining the issue, brainstorming alternatives, evaluating and choosing between these alternatives, and implementing solutions. (Paragraph 6)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
7. Developing a plan can help lessen stress that comes from the unknown. (Paragraph 6)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
8. Sigmund Freud, the famous psychoanalyst who was the first person to study the significance of dreams, is credited with popularizing the idea of denial. (Paragraph 9)
   a. subject
   b. object
   c. object of a preposition
   d. not a gerund
9. Thinking about tragic events helps people prepare for unforeseen difficult circumstances. (Paragraph 4)
   a. subject
   b. object

c. object of a preposition
d. not a gerund

10. Some literary critics believe that this is the reason why people enjoy reading about, watching, and analyzing tragedies.
    a. subject
    b. object
    c. object of a preposition
    d. not a gerund

1.2.4.2. Infinitives

Infinitives are [to + the base form of a verb]. Unlike gerunds, they can be more than a noun; they can also function as adjectives. The word "to" not followed by a base verb is more than likely a preposition. "Have to" and "used to" are modals followed by a base verb; they are not infinitives. Look at the examples below.

1. I want **to live** a long happy life. (to live = infinitive)
2. I gave a gift **to** my mom. (to = preposition)
3. We studied from 6PM **to** 10PM. (to = preposition)
4. Fatima **has to** visit the embassy. (has to=modal)
5. Eçe **used to** live in Cairo, Egypt. (used to=modal)
6. Ruth is **used to** waking up early. (used to=adjective + preposition)

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Introduction to Infinitives

Video: https://youtu.be/-JjOx9KAzcE

1.2.4.2.1. Subjects

Infinitives can function as the subject of a sentence although this use is rare and sounds odd to most native speakers.

To begin a sentence with an infinitive is rare.

1.2.4.2.2. Objects

Infinitives can function as the object of a sentence. Certain verbs are followed by infinitives. See the table below and the examples that follow.

agree	appear	arrange	ask
attempt	choose	decide	demand
deserve	expect	fail	get
hope	learn	need**	offer
pay	plan	pretend	seem
strive	struggle	tend	threaten
wait	want**	advise*	allow*
ask*	encourage*	expect*	force*
invite*	order*	remind*	tell*

Table 7 Verbs Followed by Infinitives

* verb + noun/pronoun + infinitive

** verb + infinitive or verb + noun/pronoun +infinitive

1. Geraldo **wants to transfer** to a university.
2. His mother **wants him to stay** close to home.
3. Habib **offered to buy** me coffee.

For more information on this topic, watch these videos: Infinitives, Part I-'Verb +infinitive' and Infinitives, Part II-'verb + object + infinitive'

1.2.4.2.3. Infinitives of Purpose

A common use for infinitives is to provide a purpose. Look at the examples below.

1. I went to the store **to buy** the missing ingredients for tonight's dinner.
2. I am learning Arabic (in order) **to communicate** with my mother-in-law.
3. (In order) to communicate with my mother-in-law, I am learning Arabic.

If I were to ask you, "Why did I go to the store?", you might respond, "to buy the missing ingredients for tonight's dinner." Your answer is the reason or purpose. The second and third examples demonstrate how to use "in order to"; however, "in order" is optional. Infinitives of purpose can be at the end of the main clause or in front.

1.2.4.2.3.1. Exercise 6-Infinitives of Purpose Practice

Look at the situations below. Form sentences by adding an infinitive of purpose to the verb phrases. Share your answers with your group. Use the example as a guide.

Example: go to the store

I went to the store to buy the missing ingredients for tonight's dinner.

1. go to the beach
2. learn English
3. stop at a store
4. eat a cake
5. exercise daily
6. go to the mountains
7. sit at a table

1.2.4.2.4. Adjectives + Infinitives

Adjectives can be followed by an infinitive. Read the examples below.

1. Tomoki was **surprised to see** his mother at the store.
2. It is **important to wear** a seatbelt.

Surprised and important are adjectives. Immediately after them are infinitives.

For more information on this topic, watch these videos: Infinitives as Subject/Infinitives after Adjectives and (ESL): Infinitives After Adjectives and Nouns

1.2.4.2.4.1. Exercise 7-Adjectives + Infinitives Practice

Create sentences by adding infinitives to the adjectives below. Use the example as a guide.

Example: important

It is **important to wear** a seatbelt.

1. excited to
2. relieved to
3. sad to
4. ready to
5. determined to
6. afraid to
7. difficult to
8. dangerous to
9. impolite to
10. necessary to

1.2.4.2.5. Nouns + Infinitives

Nouns are often followed by infinitives. While most adjectives are before nouns, infinitives as adjectives are after the noun they describe. Look at the examples below.

1. Your **reluctance to help** is frustrating.
2. My **goal to lose** ten pounds is reasonable.
3. I am happy with his **decision to take** the day off.

Below is a list of common nouns that are followed by infinitives.

ability	advice	arrangement	attempt
chance	choice	decision	demand
dream	failure	goal	intention
motivation	need	offer	opportunity
permission	plan	promise	proposal
reminder	request	requirement	suggestion
tendency	way	willingness	wish

Table 8 Nouns Followed by Infinitives

*Infinitives of purpose also follow nouns; however, there is a difference. Notice in the example *I went to the store to buy the missing ingredients* the infinitive **to buy** does **not** describe **the store**. In the example *I am happy with his decision to take the day off* **to take** is describing **the decision**.

1.2.4.2.5.1. Exercise 8-Using Infinitives After Nouns

Complete the sentences using an infinitive. Be prepared to share your answers with your group.

1. I have a unique ability to…
2. Mothers might make a promise to their children to… (promise to)
3. Hasan called his friend to make a request to…
4. There are many strategies to…
5. I have made many attempts to…
6. My friend gave me advice to…
7. Mario set a reminder on his phone to… (reminder to)
8. Sarah has an opportunity to…

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1.2.4.2.6. Exercise 9-Infinitives in Chapter 2's Reading

Read the sentences below from this chapter's readings. Determine the function of the infinitive in the sentences as either a subject, object, infinitive of purpose, adjective followed by infinitive, noun followed by infinitive, or not an infinitive.

1. Anticipation is a way **to reduce** the stress of a difficult challenge. (Paragraph 4)
    a. subject
    b. object
    c. infinitive of purpose
    d. adjective followed by infinitive
    e. noun followed by infinitive
    f. not an infinitive.
2. A coping mechanism is a method **to deal** with stress or conflict. (Paragraph 1)
    a. subject
    b. object
    c. infinitive of purpose
    d. adjective followed by infinitive
    e. noun followed by infinitive
    f. not an infinitive.
3. The brain's response **to worry** enhances the effectiveness of this strategy. (Paragraph 5)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose

d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

4. It is a way for a person **to "master**" or minimize the effect of a stressful situation. (Paragraph 1)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

5. Stress releases neurohormones that strengthen your ability **to seek** emotional support. (Paragraph 5)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

6. Problem-solving can be strengthened by creativity, and it is a useful response **to** both simple and complex issues. (Paragraph 6)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

7. People of all ages and cultures respond **to** humor. (Paragraph 7)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

8. Denial is the refusal **to accept** truth or fact. (Paragraph 9)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

9. He explains it as the moment when a person is faced with a fact too uncomfortable **to accept**. (Paragraph 9)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

10. Instead of facing the problem, the person decides **to reject** its existence or minimize its importance despite overwhelming evidence proving the contrary. (Paragraph 9)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose

d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

11. In extreme cases, a person who has dissociative behavior may even invent a new imaginary world where they do not have **to face** an uncomfortable feeling or memory. (Paragraph 11)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

12. While dealing with stress, it is important **to prioritize** your physical, mental, and social well-being. (Paragraph 12)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

13. It is also important **to maintain** your mental health. (Paragraph 12)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

14. It is when a person tries **to "disconnect**" from a traumatic or stressful event. (Paragraph 11)

a. subject
b. object
c. infinitive of purpose
d. adjective followed by infinitive
e. noun followed by infinitive
f. not an infinitive.

1.2.4.3. Gerund and Infinitive Practice

Some verbs can be followed by a gerund or an infinitive with no change in meaning. The table below lists these verbs.

begin	continue	hate	like
love	prefer	propose	start

Table 9 Verbs Followed by Either a Gerund or Infinitive with No Significant Change in Meaning

There are some verbs that can be followed by a gerund and infinitive, but there is a significant change in the meaning. Look at the examples below. What is the difference in meaning?

Cynthia stopped smoking. = Cynthia quit smoking.

Cynthia stopped to smoke. = Cynthia stopped doing something so that she can smoke.

In the examples, using a gerund or infinitive determines whether Cynthia smoked or not. That's a big difference in meaning. The table below lists the verbs that can be followed by a gerund or infinitive with a significant difference to the meaning.

forget	quit	regret	remember
stop	try		

Table 10 Verbs Followed by a Gerund or Infinitive with a Significant Change in Meaning

For more information on this topic, watch this video: Infinitives, Part III-'verb + (object) + infinitive' with a change in meaning!

Video: https://youtu.be/8y3Oed9Xwl0

1.2.4.3.1. Exercise 10-Change in meaning?

Look at the numbered sentence pairs. Is there a difference in meaning? If so, select "difference"; if they have the same meaning, select "same."

1. Felipe hates going to the dentist. Felipe hates to go to the dentist.
a. different
b. same
2. Tamara tried to shut the window. Tamara tried shutting the window.
a. different
b. same
3. Lee started studying every day. Lee started to study every day.
a. different
b. same
4. Sukinah loves to receive flowers. Sukinah loves receiving flowers.
a. different
b. same
5. I regret saying those words. I regret to say these words.
a. different
b. same
6. Laura forgot to give him the message. Laura forgot giving him the message.
a. different
b. same
7. Hadi continues to make progress with his behavior. Hadi continues making progress with his behavior.
a. different
b. same
8. Mai prefers to join a club on campus. Mai prefers joining a club on campus.
a. different
b. same
9. Alejandro remembers to pack a lunch. Alejandro remembers packing a lunch.
a. different
b. same
10. Reza stopped drinking soda. Reza stopped to drink a soda.
a. different
b. same

1.2.4.3.2. Exercise 11-Difference in meaning

Read the sentences below and decide the intended meaning.

1. The man forgot to turn in his homework.
a. The man did not turn in his homework. He forgot.
b. The man turned in his homework, then forgot that he did.

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Image 9 Photo by *Pixaby CC BY*

2. The man forgot turning in his homework.
a. The man did not turn in his homework. He forgot.
b. The man turned in his homework, then forgot that he did.
3. My son remembered to set his alarm.
a. My son set his alarm. He didn't forget.
b. My son remembers the time that he set his alarm.

4. My son remembered setting his alarm.
a. My son set his alarm. He didn't forget.
b. My son remembers the time that he set his alarm.
5. The boy stopped to pick a flower.
a. The boy stopped an activity so that he can pick a flower.
b. The boy used to pick flower, but now he's quit.
6. The boy stopped picking flowers.
a. The boy stopped an activity so that he can pick a flower.
b. The boy used to pick flower, but now he's quit.
7. I regret to tell you that you didn't get accepted.
a. I am giving you bad news, and I don't want to give you the bad news.
b. I told you something in the past, but I regret telling you. I should not have told you.
8. I regret telling you that you didn't get accepted.
a. I am telling you the secret now, and I don't want to tell you.
b. I told you the message in the past, but I regret telling you. I should not have told you.

1.2.4.3.3. Exercise 12-Gerund or Infinitive?

Complete the sentences below with a gerund or infinitive. Use the tables from the gerund and infinitive sections to guide you.

1. Isaac agreed _____ to Disneyland with us.
a. to go
b. going
2. I denied _____ the last slice of cake.
a. to take
b. taking
3. Melissa enjoys _____ for her patients in the hospital. She's a great nurse.
a. to care
b. caring
4. We plan _____ a new house next year.
a. to buy
b. buying
5. Elijah keeps _____ late. He never arrives on time!
a. to wake up
b. waking up
6. I appreciate you _____ me time to prepare for the meeting.
a. to give
b. giving
7. The boy wants _____ at his grandmother's house, but he must go home.
a. to stay
b. staying
8. The teacher promised _____ the final grades by Monday morning.
a. to give
b. giving
9. The teacher suggested _____ an appointment with a counselor.
a. to make
b. making
10. Mufeed refused _____ to the doctor even though he was in so much pain.
a. to go
b. going
11. Jorge's classmates finished _____ the exam, but he wasn't finished yet.
a. to take

b. taking

12. Irene imagined _____ in a log cabin surrounded by nature.

a. to relax

b. relaxing

13. Sarah avoids _____ too much sugar.

a. to eat

b. eating

14. Children sometimes pretend _____ superheroes.

a. to be

b. being

15. I hesitate _____ money from my parents.

a. to borrow

b. borrowing

16. Jawad considered _____ another food truck, but he decided _____.

a. to open, to wait

b. to open, waiting

c. opening, waiting

d. opening, to wait

17. Robert went _____ with his friends.

a. to shop

b. shopping

18. Students need _____ their responsibilities and time.

a. to manage

b. managing

19. I can't afford _____ expensive, fancy coffee every day. I don't have enough money.

a. to buy

b. buying

20. Zainab misses _____ her neighbors when she walks in the mornings.

a. to see

b. seeing

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1.2.4.3.4. Exercise 13-Correcting Errors

All of the following sentences contain a mistake. Find the mistakes, highlight and correct them. The first one is done for you as an example.

1. He read the whole book **without** use a dictionary. without using
2. She insisted in driving me home.
3. I enjoy to walk in the park.
4. He went to shop after work.
5. I decided buy a new car.
6. Find a good job is important.
7. Is important to find a good job.
8. I decided to bought a new car.
9. He wants that I drive.
10. It's important to me to find a job.
11. I called the company for make an appointment.
12. I use to live with my parents. Now I live alone.
13. The teacher expects we do the homework.
14. It's necessary for he to be on time.

15. I need to went to the library last weekend.

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Links on the original page

- Gerunds and Gerund Phrases as Objects of Prepositions: https://youtu.be/CEcdud_Z_6c
- Introduction to Infinitives: https://youtu.be/-JjOx9KAzcE
- Infinitives, Part II-‘verb + object + infinitive’: https://youtu.be/bwaDmVNrdIg
- Infinitives as Subject/Infinitives after Adjectives: https://youtu.be/xGeoxmeogas
- (ESL): Infinitives After Adjectives and Nouns: https://youtu.be/GoG3qi5BuUg
- Infinitives, Part III-‘verb + (object) + infinitive’ with a change in meaning!: https://youtu.be/8y3Oed9XwIo

2.5: Communication Practice

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

1.2.5.1. Exercise 14-Find Someone Who...

Get to know your classmates by asking them questions using gerunds. Write their name if their answer is yes. Do not write their name if their answer is no. Ask follow up questions to keep the conversation going. Use the example to guide you.

Example: Enjoys playing sports

Do you enjoy playing sports?

Yes.

What types of sports do you play?

1. enjoys playing sports
2. believes dancing is fun
3. likes to go camping
4. puts off doing his/her laundry
5. practices speaking English everyday
6. plans on traveling during the holidays
7. is interested in taking more classes at Contra Costa College
8. is proud of having wonderful children
9. dreams about winning the lottery

1.2.5.2. Exercise 15-Infinitive Practice

Interview a partner using the questions below. Write your partner's answers in complete sentences.

1. What do you hope to do next year?
2. What is something that you refuse to do?
3. What is something you are not permitted to do?
4. What is necessary for you to do every day?
5. What are you ready to do after class?
6. What is difficult for new immigrants to do?
7. Where do you hope to go on your next vacation?

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Gerunds and Infinitives

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Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

5.4.1. Verbs Followed by Gerunds

admit	anticipate	appreciate	avoid
consider	defend	delay	deny
discontinue	discuss	dislike	enjoy
explain	fear	finish	go (expression)
imagine	keep	mention	miss
practice	recommend	suggest	understand

Table 33 Verbs Followed by Gerunds

5.4.2. Verbs Followed by Infinitives

agree	appear	arrange	ask
attempt	choose	decide	demand
deserve	expect	fail	get
hope	learn	need**	offer
pay	plan	pretend	seem
strive	struggle	tend	threaten
wait	want**	advise*	allow*
ask*	encourage*	expect*	force*
invite*	order*	remind*	tell*

Table 34 Verbs Followed by Infinitives

* verb + noun/pronoun + infinitive

** verb + infinitive or verb + noun/pronoun +infinitive

1. Geraldo **wants to transfer** to a university.
2. His mother **wants him to stay** close to home.
3. Habib **offered to buy** me coffee.

5.4.3. Nouns Followed by Infinitives

ability	advice	arrangement	attempt
chance	choice	decision	demand
dream	failure	goal	intention
motivation	need	offer	opportunity
permission	plan	promise	proposal
reminder	request	requirement	suggestion
tendency	way	willingness	wish

Table 35 Nouns Followed by Infinitives

*Infinitives of purpose also follow nouns; however, there is a difference. Notice in the example *I went to the store to buy the missing ingredients* the infinitive **to buy** does **not** describe **the store**. In the example *I am happy with his decision to take the day off* **to**

take is describing **the decision**.

5.4.4. Verbs Followed by Either a Gerund or Infinitive with No Significant Change in Meaning

begin	continue	hate	like
love	prefer	propose	start

Table 36 Verbs Followed by Either a Gerund or Infinitive with No Significant Change in Meaning

5.4.5. Verbs Followed by a Gerund or Infinitive with a Significant Change in Meaning

forget	quit	regret	remember
stop	try		

Table 37 Verbs Followed by a Gerund or Infinitive with a Significant Change in Meaning

5.4.6. Verb Tense in Direct and Reported Speech

Number	Direct Speech	Reported Speech	Change
1.	The student said, “I study hard.”	He said *that he studied hard.	simple present to simple past
2.	The student **says, “I study hard.”	He says *that he studies hard.	no verb tense change
3.	He said, “I am studying hard.”	He said *that he was studying hard.	present progressive to past progressive
4.	He said, “I will study hard.	He said *that he would study hard.	simple future will to would
5.	He said, “I am going to study hard.”	He said *that he was going to study hard.	future “be going to” to “was/were going to”
6.	He **says, “I am going to study hard.”	He says *that he is going to study hard.	no verb tense change
7.	He said, “I can study hard.”	He said *that he could study hard.	can to could
8.	He said, “I have studied hard.	He said *that he had studied hard.	present perfect to past perfect
9.	He **says, “I have studied hard.”	He says *that he has studied hard.	no verb tense change
10.	He said, “I studied hard.”	He said *that he had studied hard.	simple past to past perfect
11.	He told them, “Do your homework.”	He told them to do their homework.	imperative to infinitive
12.	He asked, “Do you want a job?”	He asked if I wanted a job.	yes or no question to if or whether or not (for alternatives)

Table 38 Verb Tense in Direct and Reported Speech

*The word “that” is optional in the reported speech sentences. In fact, native speakers usually do not say the “that.” It is understood to be there by native speakers, however. Common verbs used for reporting words are as follows: say, tell, ask, inquire, respond, answer, reply, state, comment, report, complain, announce, explain, remark, note. In reported speech, these verbs are almost always used in the past tense.

**When the reporting verb (for example, say) is in the simple present, present perfect, or simple future, the reported speech does not change tense from the direct speech. When the reporting verb is in the present tense, this usually indicates immediate reporting, so the indirect speech is in the simple present.